

Group #10: Olga Fedossenko, Ahd Shahrouri, Kareem Sayyah, Vedant Thakur, Sisvia Nathans

Institute of Communications, Culture, Information & Technology

CCT 204: Design Thinking I

A5: Usability Test Report: Enhancing User Experience on the Daily Mail News Website

March 21, 2024

Table of Contents

1. Introduction	3
2. Methodology	3
2.1 A/B Testing	
2.2 Task-based Testing.....	
3. Research Findings.....	3
3.1 Insights from Olga's Testing Session	
3.2 Insights from Ah's Testing Session	
4. Recommendations.....	4
4.1 Expand Personalization Options	
4.2 Refine Navigation Structure	
4.3 Streamline User Feedback Mechanisms	
5. Visual Demonstration of Design Journey.....	4
5.1 Prototype Link	
5.2 Visual Demo Presentation.....	
6. Learning/Reflections.....	4

Introduction

Our usability testing aimed to evaluate the efficacy of the redesigned Daily Mail news website prototype in improving user experience. This report provides insights gathered from our methodology, findings, and recommendations to refine the website's usability and engagement.

Methodology

To comprehensively assess user experience, we employed two distinct testing methodologies:

1. A/B testing
2. Task-based testing.

Due to logistical constraints, individual testing sessions were conducted by team members with volunteers, ensuring a diverse range of user perspectives. Task-based testing involved presenting participants with a series of predefined tasks, ranging from basic navigation to feature utilization, within specified time limits. We carefully recorded the time taken for each task, enabling us to measure efficiency and user interaction using our cumulative results. Recording and comparing the average time between all our tests gave us a better understanding by helping us catch areas where we had to improve test instructions or the prototype design itself. In A/B testing, participants were exposed to different versions of the website, each featuring variations in design elements, colour schemes, and layout. Feedback gathered from users allowed us to discern preferences and identify elements that gather higher engagement which is a key KPI for a newsletter website.

Research Findings

In our usability testing sessions conducted by Olga and Ahd, several key insights and suggestions emerged to guide the redesign process of the Daily Mail website.

Olga's feedback highlighted the confusion surrounding the navigation menu, particularly the lack of dropdown options. Additionally, participants expressed a desire for increased interactivity, suggesting that clickable elements like "trending" would enhance user engagement. Furthermore, the users she tested mentioned the conceptual similarity between "like" and "save" buttons, asking her, the tester, what was the difference between those two.

Ahd's test session also provided further valuable insights. Participants expressed a need for clearer pathways for accessing liked articles, suggesting the creation of a dedicated page for such content. Additionally, feedback indicated a desire for a reduced space occupied by the margins. However, since our group used the desktop view for the largest screen on Figma, we decided not to reduce the space too much. The website is meant to be opened on a large screen.

There were also recommendations to expand the category options under the browse button for improved navigation clarity. Furthermore, participants suggested resizing elements such as login and register buttons for a more cohesive visual experience. Enhancements to the footer were also proposed, including the addition of Gmail sharing functionality and replicating header categories for consistency. Moreover, suggestions to improve readability through larger font sizes and optimize the placement of interactive buttons on article pages were highlighted.

Recommendations

Expand Personalization Options: To further cater to user preferences, we recommend continuously evolving personalization features. Consider integrating additional customization options, such as personalized recommendations or customizable user profiles, to empower users with greater control over their content consumption experience.

Refine Navigation Structure: To ensure intuitive and seamless user journeys, we advocate for regular review and optimization of the website's navigation structure. Conducting periodic usability testing will aid in identifying and addressing any emerging navigation challenges, ensuring that users can effortlessly navigate the website and access desired content.

Streamline User Feedback Mechanisms: Implementing streamlined feedback mechanisms is crucial in fostering user engagement and satisfaction. Explore alternative methods, such as user surveys or feedback prompts integrated into the browsing experience, to gather actionable insights effectively. By soliciting and leveraging user feedback, we can iteratively refine and enhance the website to better align with user needs and preferences.

Visual Demonstration of Design Journey

1. [Final Prototype Link](#)

Learning/Reflections

Through this usability testing process, we've gained a deeper understanding of the critical role that diverse user perspectives play in revealing insights and preferences. The feedback emphasized the importance of intuitive navigation, streamlined functionality, and personalized experiences in boosting user engagement. Challenges encountered during the redesign of The Daily Mail included redesigning functions by considering the usability testing feedback, we had to design the website through the users' eyes and design some key functions such as the navigation more accessible, adding more ads visible and positioning the ads we're difficult.